Basic Percentages

Exam code: 0607

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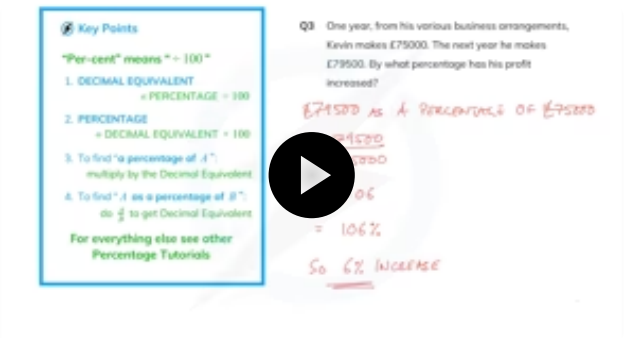

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Basic percentages

What is a percentage?

- "Per-cent" simply means "out of 100" (or "÷ 100")
- Rewriting fractions as percentages means they can be **compared** more easily
- You can do this by finding an equivalent fraction with a **denominator of 100**
  - $\frac{1}{2} = \frac{50}{100} = 50\%$
  - $\frac{2}{5} = \frac{40}{100} = 40\%$
  - $\frac{3}{4} = \frac{75}{100} = 75\%$
  - The three percentages are much easier to compare than the three fractions
- Percentages are also **equivalent to decimals**
  - $100\% = 1$
    $10\% = 0.1$
    $1\% = 0.01$
    $0.1\% = 0.001$
  - $25\% = 0.25$
    $2.5\% = 0.025$
    $0.25\% = 0.0025$
- Notice that a **decimal** can be converted **to a percentage** by **multiplying by 100**

Help me understand

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

decimal equivalent
    - You could use your calculator to do this
    - E.g. $\frac{234}{650} = 234 \div 650 = 0.36 = 36\%$

How do I find a percentage of an amount without a calculator?

- There are some percentages of an amount that are easy to work out
    - To find **50%**, **halve** the amount
    - To find **25%**, **halve** the amount **twice** (finding a **quarter**)
    - To find **10%**, **divide** the amount **by 10**
    - To find **1%**, **divide** the amount **by 100**

- These percentages can then be used as **building blocks** to find other percentages, for example:
    - To find **20%**, find 10% and then double it
    - To find **5%**, find 10% and halve it
    - To find **0.1%**, find 1% and divide it by 10
    - To find **12%**, find 10% and 1%, then add together the 10% and two lots of the 1%

- To find a percentage **larger than 100%**, remember that **100% is the original amount**
    - To find **150%**, find 50% and add it on to the original amount

How do I find a percentage of an amount with a calculator?

- Whilst the methods above can be used with a calculator it is more efficient to use **multipliers**
- A multiplier is the **decimal equivalent** of a percentage
- E.g. To find **12% of 650**
    - Write 12% as a decimal multiplier
        - 12% is equivalent to 0.12
    - Find the product of the amount and the multiplier, using your calculator
        - 0.12 × 650 = **78**
    - So 12% of 650 is 78

- When finding a percentage **larger than 100%**, the multiplier will be **greater than 1**
    - The multiplier for finding 126% of an amount would be 1.26

How do I express one number as a percentage of another?

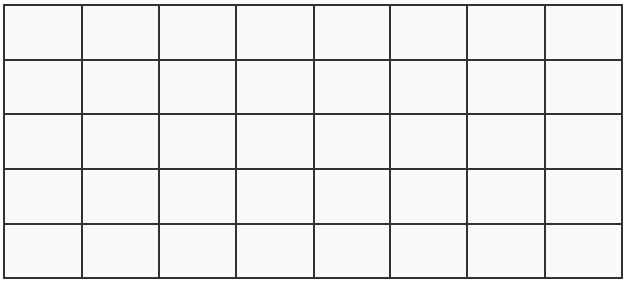
- Start by writing one number **as a fraction of the other**
- Find the **decimal equivalent** of this fraction using your calculator
    - **or** find an equivalent fraction with a **denominator of 100**

- Rewrite this as a percentage
- E.g. To find 7 as a percentage of 20

- This is equivalent to 0.35 or $\frac{35}{100}$
- So 7 is 35% of 20

Worked Example

Shade 35% of the grid below.



Answer:

Count the total number of squares in the grid

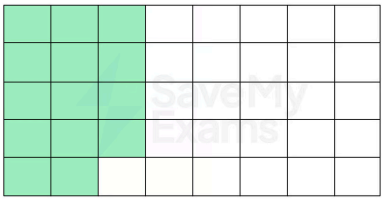
Total of 40 squares

Find 35% of 40
Start by finding 10%, to help find 5% and 30%

10% of 40 = 4
so 30% of 40 = 4 × 3 = 12
and 5% of 40 = 4 ÷ 2 = 2

35% of 40 = 12 + 2 = 14

Shade 14 squares
It doesn't matter which 14 you shade



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Worked Example

Amber owes £1200 for a trip. She has to pay a deposit of £150 to secure her place.

Express the deposit as a percentage of the price of the trip.

Answer:

Write 150 as a fraction of 1200

$$\frac{150}{1200}$$

$$\frac{150}{1200} = 0.125$$

Write this as the equivalent percentage (by multiplying by 100)

12.5 %

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